

Australian net overseas migration, jobs, growth and higher education - Labor, Coalition and One Nation settings compared - One-Pager

What the simulator is and what you see

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Forward view only, three election cycles to the end of May 2034

This is an interactive system dynamics simulator. It compares the Labor, Coalition and One Nation migration settings on one baseline and follows each through to the economy and to the international education sector: net overseas migration, temporary and bridging visa holders, housing, unemployment, skills shortages, GDP, international students by provider type, allocation use under Ministerial Direction 115, source markets and three archetype providers. It runs in a browser with nothing to install, from today (October 2026) to the end of May 2034 (three federal election cycles).

Standing. The model is calibrated, not illustrative: it was fitted to the 2018-2026 record from the ABS, Home Affairs, the Department of Education and Jobs and Skills Australia and tested against it, in the system dynamics tradition developed by Forrester at MIT. It passed the parity, lever and forward tests; its accepted limitations are recorded with the reasons: the pandemic quarters are reproduced in shape, not size, and the sector counts people where the published data count courses, so sector levels are read as direction. The validation evidence is in the Narrative Report and the Model Components reference (not provided on the iMORSE website, but integral to the iMORSE modelling methodology). Read shapes, not points: forward runs are scenarios, not forecasts.

What you see. Headline tiles, charts of every stock and outcome the comparison turns on, two scenarios (A solid, B dashed) and a row of preset buttons, one per party setting, sector test and ambition. Under current settings, reported net overseas migration falls from 301,814 today to 264,914 at the end of May 2034; unemployment ends at 5.0%, growth in GDP per person at 0.21% a year, university allocation use at 40% and archetype B's revenue at 70% of 2025. Dash-dot lines mark the end of each federal term (May 2028, May 2031, May 2034).

The levers. Labor package (announced 17 Sep 2026); Labor legislation passes; Coalition housing rule; Coalition ceiling: persons per completed dwelling; One Nation package; One Nation legislation passes; One Nation net NOM target (first three years); One Nation ceiling (from July

2031); One Nation cut to temporary grants; Permanent Migration Program planning level; International student planning level; Working holiday second-year ballot places; Visitor no-further-stay: share of onshore applications stopped; Compliance removal capacity; Review tribunal decision capacity; Underlying student visa demand; Underlying skilled temporary visa demand; Underlying working holiday demand; Underlying dwelling commencements; Labour productivity growth (from today); Structural (full-employment) unemployment rate; Domestic entry to skilled work; Demand offset: jobs created by new residents; Upward-only rule: reading; University international fee; Private higher education international fee; Private higher education allocation (2026 split); MD115: share of applicants lost to slower processing; Archetype A fee (private city non-university); Archetype B fee (mid-tier metropolitan university); Archetype C fee (domestic-focused specialist).

The question for the reader. Which party setting gets migration where it wants it, at what cost in unemployment, shortages, growth per person and the education sector's income - and which ambitions sit outside migration policy altogether?